

영어 독해 · 대의 파악: 주제·요지·제목 · 문제편

영어 · 독해 · 대의 파악: 주제·요지·제목 · SKY 멘토 × AI 협업 출제

[기본] 1 [3점] 다음 글의 요지로 가장 적절한 것은?

Many productivity guides insist that willpower is the engine of achievement — that if we simply push harder, we will accomplish more. Yet decades of behavioral research suggest the opposite. Willpower is a finite resource that depletes with each act of self-control, so relying on it as a primary strategy virtually guarantees failure by the end of a demanding day. The individuals who consistently perform well are rarely those with iron discipline. Instead, they are people who have quietly restructured their environments so that the desired behavior requires almost no decision at all. A writer who leaves a blank document open overnight, or a runner who sleeps in workout clothes, is not being more disciplined; they have simply reduced the friction that willpower would otherwise have to overcome. Design, not determination, is what sustains behavior over the long term.

- ① 목표 달성을 위해서는 강한 의지력을 꾸준히 단련해야 한다.
- ② 생산성 지침서는 과학적 근거 없이 조언을 남발하는 경향이 있다.
- ③ 지속적 행동 변화는 의지력보다 환경을 설계함으로써 이루어진다.
- ④ 성취도가 높은 사람은 예외 없이 철저한 자기 규율을 지닌다.
- ⑤ 하루 일과의 후반부에는 중요한 결정을 미루는 것이 현명하다.

[기본] 2 [3점] 다음 글의 주제로 가장 적절한 것은?

When a coral reef bleaches, most people picture a sudden catastrophe. In reality, the whiteness we observe is the visible end point of a slow negotiation that has been failing for months. Corals live in partnership with microscopic algae that provide them with color and most of their food through photosynthesis. When water grows persistently too warm, this partnership becomes metabolically unprofitable: the algae begin producing damaging compounds under heat stress, and the coral expels them to survive the short term — at the cost of losing its primary food source. Bleaching, then, is not death but a desperate gamble, a severing of a relationship that had turned harmful. Understanding it this way reframes reefs not as fragile ornaments but as ecosystems constantly renegotiating the terms of their most fundamental alliances.

- ① the biochemical mechanism by which algae produce coral coloration
- ② coral bleaching as the breakdown of a mutually beneficial partnership under stress
- ③ the economic consequences of coral reef loss for coastal communities
- ④ why warm water accelerates photosynthesis in marine organisms
- ⑤ methods for restoring bleached coral reefs to their original state

[기본] 3 [3점] 다음 글의 제목으로 가장 적절한 것은?

We tend to treat forgetting as a defect, a leak in the mind's bucket that ought to be sealed. But a memory system that retained everything would be paralyzed. Imagine recalling, with equal vividness, every parking spot you have ever used; the useful one — where you parked this morning — would drown in a flood of the irrelevant. Forgetting is not the failure of memory but one of its most sophisticated functions: it is the process that discards the outdated so the current can surface. The brain does not passively lose information; it actively prunes, prioritizing what remains predictive of the future. In this light, a person who never forgot would not be blessed with perfect recall — they would be trapped in an unusable archive of the past.

- ① Forgetting: A Hidden Skill, Not a Flaw
- ② How to Train Your Brain to Never Forget
- ③ The Tragic Cost of a Failing Memory
- ④ Memory: The Brain's Perfect Recording Device
- ⑤ Why We Store More Than We Can Ever Use

[심화] 4 [4점] 다음 글의 요지로 가장 적절한 것은?

Conventional wisdom holds that the more options a market offers, the better served its customers are. This assumption has quietly shaped everything from retirement plans to grocery aisles. But choice, beyond a certain threshold, imposes its own tax. Each additional option demands attention, comparison, and the emotional labor of forgoing what one did not select. Studies of consumer behavior reveal that when the number of options swells, people are more likely to defer the decision entirely, or to choose and then feel diminished satisfaction, haunted by the alternatives they rejected. This does not mean choice is bad; a world of two options is impoverished. The point is subtler: the value of choice is not linear. Beyond a modest range, additional options stop empowering and begin to burden — and a market that keeps adding them may be optimizing for the appearance of freedom rather than the experience of it.

- ① 소비자 만족을 높이려면 선택지의 수를 지속적으로 늘려야 한다.
- ② 선택지가 전혀 없는 시장은 소비자에게 가장 이상적인 환경이다.
- ③ 선택지의 가치는 일정 수준을 넘으면 오히려 부담으로 전환된다.
- ④ 소비자 행동 연구는 대개 현실의 구매 상황을 반영하지 못한다.
- ⑤ 자유의 본질은 선택할 수 있는 항목의 절대적 수에 달려 있다.

[심화] 5 [4점] 다음 글의 제목으로 가장 적절한 것은?

For centuries, mapmakers faced an impossible task: representing a curved planet on a flat sheet. Every projection distorts something — area, shape, distance, or direction — because these properties cannot all be preserved at once. The famous Mercator projection, for instance, keeps directions true, which made it indispensable for navigation, but at the price of grotesquely inflating landmasses near the poles. For generations, schoolchildren absorbed a subtly false picture of the world's proportions not because anyone lied, but because the map's usefulness for one purpose was mistaken for accuracy in all. The lesson extends far beyond cartography. Every model — economic, statistical, scientific — is a projection: it sacrifices fidelity in some dimensions to gain clarity in others. To read a map wisely is to ask not "Is it true?" but "What did it choose to distort, and for whom?"

- ① The Mercator Map: The Greatest Error in History
- ② Every Map Lies — and That Is What Makes It Useful
- ③ How Navigators Finally Mapped the Round Earth
- ④ Toward a Single Map That Distorts Nothing
- ⑤ The Decline of Paper Maps in a Digital Age

[킬러] 6 [4점] 다음 글의 요지로 가장 적절한 것은?

It is comforting to believe that scientific progress moves by accumulation — that each generation adds a brick to a rising wall of truth. Historians of science tell a stranger story. Consider that the theory replaced was often not "wrong" in the eyes of those who held it; it explained their data, predicted their observations, and resisted anomalies with ingenious adjustments. What ultimately toppled it was rarely a single decisive experiment. More often, a rival framework arose that made previously invisible questions suddenly askable, and previously respectable questions suddenly meaningless. The old theory was not so much refuted as abandoned — left behind not because it failed on its own terms, but because a new set of terms made its problems no longer worth solving. If this is so, then progress in science is less the steady approach toward a fixed truth than a succession of shifts in what counts as a question worth asking. The unsettling implication is that our present confidence, however well earned, tells us little about which of our questions our successors will find quaint.

- ① 과학은 결정적 실험을 통해 오류를 제거하며 진리에 근접해 간다.
- ② 낡은 이론은 자체 기준의 실패로 반증되어 폐기되는 것이 일반적이다.
- ③ 과학의 진보는 진리로의 누적적 접근이라기보다 '유의미한 질문'의 교체에 가깝다.
- ④ 과거 과학자들의 이론은 데이터를 설명하지 못했기에 계승되지 못했다.
- ⑤ 현재 과학의 확신은 미래에도 변함없이 유효할 것임을 보장한다.

[킬러] 7 [4점] 다음 글의 제목으로 가장 적절한 것은?

We praise resilience as if it were an unambiguous good: the capacity to absorb shock and return to normal. But return to normal is precisely the problem when the normal is what produced the shock. A financial system engineered for resilience may recover swiftly from each crisis — and in recovering, faithfully rebuild the very conditions that made the crisis inevitable. Ecologists have a sharper vocabulary here. They distinguish resilience, which restores a system to its prior state, from transformation, which allows a system to reorganize into a genuinely different one. A forest that always regrows the same trees after every fire is resilient; but if the climate has shifted, that very fidelity may doom it. The uncomfortable truth is that in a changing world, the ability to bounce back can be indistinguishable from the inability to move on. Sometimes what looks like strength is only a well-practiced refusal to change.

- ① Resilience: The Ultimate Measure of a Healthy System
- ② When Bouncing Back Becomes a Refusal to Move Forward
- ③ How Forests Recover Faster After Repeated Fires
- ④ Rebuilding Financial Systems for Maximum Stability
- ⑤ The Shared Language of Ecology and Economics

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